

How do roots work?

Most plants have roots, which anchor the plant in the ground. Roots soak up vital water from the soil, along with the dissolved minerals that the plant uses to grow. Grasses have tufts of fibrous roots, but most other plants grow at least one taproot, which then sprouts smaller lateral (side) roots that spread outward.

Taproot > As a seed starts to grow, one or more strong roots push down into the soil. This is the plant's taproot, and it grows only at its tip, forcing soil particles aside with a tough root cap as it grows deeper into the ground.

Leaf > A plant's leaves use the energy from sunlight to make sugar. Water is drawn up through the roots and sugary sap moves down from the leaves, powering the plant's growth.

Burdock
root

